CONSTITUTION OF THE INDEPENDENT INTERFRATERNITY COUNCIL OF RENO, NEVADA

MISSION

We, the Independent Interfraternity Council of Reno, Nevada set forth this Constitution and Bylaws in order to cause closer working relationships and coordination among its Member Fraternities in accordance with the policies and standards established by the North-American Interfraternity Conference (NIC).

ARTICLE I – NAME

This organization shall be known as the Independent Interfraternity Council (IFC) of Reno, Nevada.

ARTICLE II – PURPOSE OF THE IFC

The purpose of the IFC shall be to:

A. provide a sovereign governance structure for its Member Fraternities;
B. promote the interests of its Member Fraternities;
C. promote the interests of men's fraternities in general;
D. discuss questions of mutual interest and present to its Member Fraternities such recommendations as the IFC deems appropriate;

E. promote mutual cooperation between its Member Fraternities;
F. promote mutual cooperation between the IFC, fellow governing councils, and student organizations; and
G. promote mutual cooperation between the IFC, students, faculty, staff, and local community.

ARTICLE III – IFC MEMBERSHIP

Section I. Membership Eligibility

Membership in the IFC is open to chapters and colonies of fraternities composed of University of Nevada, Reno students, as follows:

A. Any chapter or colony of a North-American Interfraternity Conference (NIC) member organization shall hold membership in the IFC.
B. Any chapter or colony of a local, state, regional, or inter/national fraternity, which is not a member of the NIC, may hold membership in the IFC.

Section II. Membership Classification for Member Fraternities

The membership classification of Member Fraternities shall be as follows

A. Full Member: Any fraternity chapter which has obtained its charter from its inter/national organization, or any local fraternity chapter. Full Membership grants the Member Fraternity all rights, privileges and responsibilities under the IFC Constitution and Bylaws.
B. Associate Member: Any fraternity colony of an inter/national organization. Associate Membership grants the Member Fraternity all rights, privileges, and responsibilities under the IFC Constitution and By-Laws, except that it cannot hold IFC Executive Board positions nor have an IFC Judicial Committee Justice.
C. Any chapter or colony of a North-American Interfraternity Conference (NIC) member organization, or local, state, regional, or inter/national fraternity, which is not a member of the NIC, is subject to a majority vote, to gain membership, held by the active IIFC board and presidents of active chapters and colonies of the IIFC.

For the purpose of this Constitution and the IFC Bylaws, both Full Members and Associate Members are referred to as Member Fraternities.

Section III. Member Fraternity Minimum Expectations

Each Member Fraternity shall adhere to and abide by the following minimum expectations:

A. Each Member Fraternity shall comply with all policies set forth by:
    1. The IFC Constitution, Bylaws, Code of Conduct, and other policies.
    2. The general values-based conduct of fraternity men.
B. Each Member Fraternity shall maintain a minimum annual cumulative GPA of 2.70.
C. Each Member Fraternity shall be current on all IFC dues owed.
D. Each Member Fraternity shall submit required membership rosters to the IFC President, as follows:
    1. Active Member Roster: Active Member Rosters shall be submitted within one week of the beginning of each semester.
    2. New Member Roster: New Member Rosters shall be submitted within one week of pledging any New Member.
E. Each Member Fraternity shall comply with the attendance policies for the IFC General Body and the IFC Judicial Committee, as outlined within this Constitution.

A Member Fraternity which has failed to meet any of the minimum expectations outlined in this Section shall be referred to the IFC Vice President of Judicial Affairs for potential judicial review.

Section IV. Membership Status for Member Fraternities

The membership status of Member Fraternities shall be as follows:

A. Good Standing: A Member Fraternity shall be deemed to be in Good Standing if the Member Fraternity is not currently operating under Non-Status Sanctions or Status Sanctions, as defined within the IFC Bylaws, and is currently meeting the minimum expectations outlined in Section II of this Article.
B. Good Standing on Probation: A Member Fraternity shall be deemed to be in Good Standing on Probation if the Member Fraternity is currently operating under Non-Status Sanctions and currently meets the minimum expectations outlined in Section II of this Article.
C. Poor Standing: A Member Fraternity shall be deemed to be in Poor Standing if the Member Fraternity has been placed under Suspension by the IFC or has currently failed to meet the minimum expectations outlined in Section II of this Article.

Section V. Individual Member Definitions

For the purpose of this Constitution and the IFC Bylaws, and with an understanding that each Member Fraternity may have its own terminology for internal use, individuals will be defined as follows:

A. Active Member: An Active Member shall be defined as any man who has been initiated into any member fraternity of the Independent Interfraternity Council of Nevada, Reno.
B. New Member: A New Member shall be defined as any man who has accepted a bid to join a member fraternity of the Independent Interfraternity Council of Nevada, Reno, but has not been initiated into that fraternity.
C. Potential New Member: A Potential New Member shall be defined as any man who has not accepted a bid from any fraternity.

Section VI. IFC Affirmation and Adoption of NIC Standards

The IFC will pay annual dues to the NIC and affirms and adopts the NIC Standards, and each Member Fraternity shall be required to meet the following in order to maintain IFC membership:

A. Each Member Fraternity shall communicate its values through its Ritual at least once annually;
B. Each Member Fraternity shall communicate to its Active Members and New Members the importance and benefits derived from continuous membership education throughout the undergraduate experience and encourage or require its Active Members and New Members to participate in educational programming, whether conducted by the chapter, the Interfraternity Council, University of Nevada-Reno, or independent organizations covering the following topics:
    1. Academic Achievement and Student Success
    2. Alcohol and Drug Use and Awareness
    3. Career Preparation
    4. Civic Engagement
    5. Hazing Awareness

6. Leadership Development
7. Sexual Assault/Abuse Awareness
8. Values and Ethics

C. Each Member Fraternity shall only offer bids to join the fraternity to Potential New Members who meet the following academic requirement:
   1. For a Potential New Member who has yet to establish a collegiate grade point average, a minimum high school grade point average of 2.50 is required.
   2. For a Potential New Member who has an established collegiate grade point average, a minimum collegiate grade point average of 2.50 is required.

D. Each Member Fraternity shall maintain an annual cumulative grade point average of a 2.70 or be at/or above the institution's all-men's grade point average if that grade point average is below a 2.70.

E. Each Member Fraternity shall have New Member education programs lasting no longer than twelve weeks.

F. Each Member Fraternity shall prohibit women's auxiliary groups, such as "little sisters".

G. Each Member Fraternity shall have and follow risk management policies covering the following areas:
   1. Alcohol and Drugs
   2. Hazing
   3. Sexual Abuse and Harassment
   4. Fire, Health and Safety.

H. Each Member Fraternity shall support open expansion, which is defined as the unrestricted establishment and recognition of undergraduate chapters of any NIC Member Organization through the adherence to the constitutional right of Freedom of Association.

I. Each Member Fraternity shall support open recruitment, which is defined as the ability of each Member Fraternity to recruit for membership any male who meets the minimum grade point average requirement for joining, without restrictions on the date, time and place of membership invitation, extension and acceptance.

J. Each Member Fraternity shall prohibit the use of alcohol and drugs by all Active Members, New Members and Potential New Members during all recruitment activities.

K. Each Member Fraternity shall prohibit the use of alcohol and drugs by all Active Members and New Members during all New Member educational programming.

L. Each Member Fraternity shall prohibit hazing, as defined by their inter/national organization, within all aspects of formal and informal chapter operations.

ARTICLE IV – IFC GENERAL BODY

Section I. IFC General Body

The powers of the IFC shall be vested in the IFC General Body. The IFC General Body shall be the governing legislative body responsible for the general policies of the IFC, for electing its Executive Board, and for instructing its Executive Board as to the activities and operations of the IFC. All such activities shall respect the individual sovereignty and associational rights of each Member Fraternity and shall not relinquish any governance authority to any other governing body.

Section II. IFC General Body Composition

The IFC General Body shall be composed of voting IFC Representatives from each Member Fraternity.

Section III. IFC Representatives

Each Member Fraternity shall have one IFC Representative, chosen by that Member Fraternity, who serves on the IFC General Body.

Section IV. IFC Alternate Representatives

Each Member Fraternity may also choose an IFC Alternate Representative, who shall represent that Member Fraternity in the IFC General Body in the absence of its IFC Representative.

Section V. IFC Representative and Alternate Representative Eligibility

In order to serve as the IFC Representative or Alternate Representative for a Member Fraternity, individuals must meet the following requirements:

A. Be an Active Member or New Member, in good standing, of a Member Fraternity.
B. Maintain good academic standing with the University of Nevada, Reno
C. Be devoted to the general ideals and principles of fraternity life and conduct himself in a professional manner consistent with the Mission and Purpose of the IFC, as defined within this Constitution.
D. Have a working knowledge of the IFC Constitution and Bylaws, University of Nevada, Reno policies, NIC Standards, and FIPG risk management policies.
E. Not be a current member of the IFC Executive Board or currently serve as his Member Fraternity's IFC Judicial Committee Justice.

Section VI. Term of Office of IFC Representatives

The term of office for IFC Representatives shall be until their graduation, resignation, or replacement under the procedures determined by each Member Fraternity; or upon his election to serve on the IFC Executive Board or as his Member Fraternity's IFC Justice for the IFC Judicial Committee.

A. Elections Shall be held on in the First week of December in every calendar year.
B. One Full term shall last a full calendar year.

Section VII. IFC General Body Meeting Polices

The IFC General Body shall conduct its meetings according to the following requirements:

A. The most recent edition of Robert's Rules of Order shall be used to run all meetings.
B. A majority of Member Fraternities present shall constitute a quorum in order to conduct IFC General Body business.
C. The IFC General Body shall conduct regularly scheduled business meetings at least twice a month during the academic year.
D. Special meetings may be called by the IFC President at any time or at the request of two Member Fraternities, with notice of the time, location, and purpose of the special meeting provided to all Member Fraternities at least 72 hours in advance.
E. Each Member Fraternity's IFC Representative or Alternate Representative is required to attend all meetings of the IFC. More than two absences per academic year shall result in the Member Fraternity being referred to the IFC Vice President of Judicial Affairs for potential judicial review.

Section VIII. IFC General Body Voting Policies

The IFC General Body shall operate utilizing the following voting policies:

A. Each Member Fraternity, in good standing, shall have one vote.
B. Individuals holding IFC Executive Board positions are not entitled to a vote.
C. In the event of a tie, the IFC President shall cast the deciding vote.
D. With the exception of the election of IFC Executive Board positions, there shall be no secret ballot votes.

ARTICLE V – IFC EXECUTIVE BOARD

Section I. IFC Executive Board

The IFC Executive Board shall be responsible for carrying out the purpose and policies of the IFC and for its day-to-day operations and activities, as directed by the IFC General Body.

Section II. IFC Executive Board Composition

The IFC executive board shall consist of no more than two officers from the same fraternity at one time if the body membership is comprised of four or more member chapters. The IFC Executive Board shall be composed of the following positions with duties and responsibilities outlined within the IFC Bylaws:

A. President
B. Vice President of Judicial Affairs
C. Vice President of Recruitment
D. Vice President of Finance
E. Vice President of Scholarship

F. Vice President of Member Development
G. Vice President of Community Relations

Section III. IFC Executive Board Eligibility

In order to be elected and serve as a member of the IFC Executive Board, individuals must meet the following requirements:

A. Be an Active Member or New Member, in good standing, of a Member Fraternity.
B. Maintain good academic standing with the University of Nevada, Reno
C. Be devoted to the general ideals and principles of fraternity life and conduct himself in a professional manner consistent with the Mission and Purpose of the IFC, as defined within this Constitution.
D. Have a working knowledge of the IFC Constitution and Bylaws, University of Nevada, Renopolicies, NIC Standards, and FIPG risk management policies.
F. Not currently serve as his Member Fraternity's IFC Representative, Alternate Representative, or IFC Judicial Committee Justice.
G. Must complete formal judicial policies and procedures training.

Section IV. IFC Executive Board Meeting Polices

The IFC Executive Board shall conduct its meetings according to the following requirements:

A. The most recent edition of Robert's Rules of Order shall be used to run all meetings.
B. A majority of IFC Executive Board members present shall constitute a quorum in order to conduct IFC Executive Board business.
C. The IFC Executive Board shall conduct regularly scheduled meetings on a weekly basis.
D. Special meetings may be called by the IFC President with notice of the time, location, and purpose of the special meeting provided to each IFC Executive Board member at least 72 hours in advance.
H. Each IFC Executive Board member is required to attend all meetings of the IFC Executive Board and all meetings of the IFC General Body. Absences may result in removal from office.

Section V. IFC Executive Board Voting Policies

The IFC Executive Board shall operate utilizing the following voting policies during IFC Executive Board meetings:

A. Each IFC Executive Board member shall have one vote.
B. The IFC President should refrain from casting his vote except for in the event of a tie. In such instances, the IFC President shall cast the deciding vote.
C. There shall be no secret ballot votes.

Section VI. IFC Executive Board Election Policies

The following policies and procedures shall be utilized for the election and removal of IFC Executive Board officers:

A. Nominations for IFC Executive Board positions shall open two meetings prior to the last business meeting of each calendar year.
B. Elections and installations of IFC Executive Board officers shall take place during the last business meeting of each calendar year.
C. Each IFC Executive Board officer shall be elected by a majority of the votes cast by the IFC General Body.
D. Any individual serving in an IFC Executive Board position may be removed from his position by a 2/3 affirmative vote of the IFC General Body.
E. In the event of a vacancy in any IFC Executive Board position, the IFC President shall appoint a successor to complete the term under the advice and consent of the remaining members of the IFC Executive Board.
F. Should a vacancy occur in the office of the IFC President, a special election shall be held within two meetings after the vacancy was created.

Section VII. Report of IFC Officers

A report of any newly elected or appointed IFC Executive Board officers shall be submitted to the NIC within one week of the election or appointment.

ARTICLE VI – IFC JUDICIAL COMMITTEE

Section I. IFC Judicial Committee Jurisdiction

The IFC shall be a self-governing organization with an independent Judicial Committee which shall have jurisdiction over cases involving alleged Member Fraternity violations, including but not limited to:

A. The IFC Constitution, Bylaws, Code of Conduct, and other policies.
B. The general values-based conduct of fraternity men.

Section II. IFC Judicial Committee Composition

The IFC Judicial Committee shall be composed of one IFC Justice from each Member Fraternity, chosen by that Member Fraternity, and shall be chaired by the IFC Vice President of Judicial Affairs.

Section III. IFC Justice Eligibility

In order to serve as the IFC Justice for a Member Fraternity on the IFC Judicial Committee, an individual must meet the following requirements:

A. Be an Active Member or New Member, in good standing, of an IFC Member Fraternity.
B. Maintain good academic standing with the institution.
C. Be devoted to the general ideals and principles of fraternity life and conduct himself in a professional manner consistent with the Mission and Purpose of the IFC, as defined within this Constitution.
D. Have a working knowledge of the IFC Constitution and Bylaws, University of Nevada, Renopolicies, NIC Standards, and FIPG risk management policies.

E. Not be a current member of the IFC Executive Board or serve as his Member Fraternity's IFC Representative or Alternate Representative for the IFC General Body.
I. Must complete formal judicial policies and procedures training prior to serving on an IFC Judicial Board hearing.

Section IV. Term of Office of IFC Justices

The term of office for IFC Justices shall be until their graduation, resignation, or replacement under the procedures determined by each Member Fraternity; or upon his election to serve on the IFC Executive Board or as his Member Fraternity's IFC Representative or Alternate Representative for the IFC General Body.

Section V. IFC Judicial Policy

The Judicial Committee shall perform all duties and be subject to all regulations contained within the IFC Judicial Policy in the Bylaws.

Section VI. IFC Judicial Board Hearing Justice Selection

The IFC Vice President of Judicial Affairs will select five (5) Judicial Committee justices, as predetermined by an alphabetical rotation of the Member Fraternities, to hear a case. In the event the IFC Judicial Committee rotation for service on a Judicial Board hearing falls upon an IFC Justice whose Member Fraternity is involved in the alleged violation, the rotation will skip to the next Member Fraternity in the alphabetical rotation.

Section VII. IFC Judicial Board Hearing Attendance

All IFC Judicial Board hearings shall be conducted in accordance with the following requirements:

A. All IFC Justices assigned to an IFC Judicial Board hearing shall be present in order to conduct business on behalf of the IFC Judicial Committee.
B. Each IFC Justice assigned to an IFC Judicial Board hearing is required to attend the hearing. Failure of an IFC Justice to attend an IFC Judicial Board hearing for which he was assigned shall result in his Member Fraternity being referred to the IFC Vice President of Judicial Affairs for potential judicial review.

Section VIII. IFC Judicial Board Hearing Voting Policies

All IFC Judicial Board hearings shall operate utilizing the following voting policies:

A. Each IFC Justice serving on an IFC Judicial Board hearing shall have one vote.
B. A majority vote shall govern all actions of an IFC Judicial Board.

ARTICLE VII – IFC COMMITTEES

Section I. Standing Committees

The IFC shall have the following standing committees chaired by its respective corresponding member of the IFC Executive Board:

A. Recruitment Committee
B. Finance Committee
C. Scholarship Committee
D. Member Development Committee
E. Community Relations Committee

Section II. Ad Hoc Committees

The IFC Executive Board or the IFC President may form ad hoc committees as deemed necessary to perform the work of the IFC. The IFC President shall appoint the ad hoc committee chairman and committee members with the concurrence of the IFC Executive Board.

Section III. IFC Committee Meeting Polices

All committees of the IFC shall conduct its meetings according to the following requirements:

A. The most recent edition of Robert's Rules of Order shall be used to run all meetings.
B. A majority of committee members present shall constitute a quorum in order to conduct committee business.
C. Each committee shall meet as called by its committee chair.

ARTICLE VIII – CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENTS

Section I. Constitutional Amendments

This Constitution may be amended by a three-fourths (¾) affirmative vote of the IFC General Body provided notice of the proposed amendment has been provided to Member Fraternities at the preceding regularly scheduled business meeting of the IFC General Body.

Section II. Adoption

This Constitution shall become effective and shall supersede all previous Constitutions of the IFC when adopted by a three-fourths (¾) affirmative vote of the IFC General Body.